CONSTITUTION

Indiana Zeta Colony
Purdue University

Last Amended: March 8, 2026
Effective: March 8, 2026

—Preamble—

We, the Brothers of the Indiana Zeta Chapter of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity, hereby bind ourselves together in adopting this Constitution so that we may better attain the ends for which this organization was founded.

The goal of Phi Kappa Theta at Purdue University is to develop a strong brotherhood that instills mental and moral strength through responsibility to, and respect for, God, Mankind, our Brothers, and ourselves.

The mission of Phi Kappa Theta at Purdue University develop a social, philanthropic and intellectual brotherhood through observation, participation, service, and leadership within the Chapter, University, and Community.

In attaining our purposes, we therefore encourage our members to cultivate a concern for the welfare of those among whom we dwell. We also emphasize the obligation of our members to so conduct their lives that they will bring honor to their families, their Fraternity Brothers, their College, Community, and Nation.

We also expect that every Member will identify himself with the life and activities of the general student body, never holding himself aloof, but always manifesting a public spirit and lively interest in all that concerns the life and welfare of the college, not only as a student, but also as a loyal alumnus.

—Article I. Aims, Purposes, and Objectives—

Section 1.

To completely rewrite an article of this constitution, a constitutional convention is required to convene with 100 percent vote of the entire active chapter and approval of the Indiana Zeta Alumni Board.

Section 2.

It shall be among the principal aims of this chapter to provide the tangible and intangible aids necessary to establish a closely-knit, harmonious collegiate community, whose Members may enjoy the rights and privileges therein, to encourage and to develop a mode of conduct and living that would be expected if they continued to reside among their respective families.

Section 3.

One of the principal objectives of the chapter is to render service. It bases this ideal upon the fact that man is a social creature: that Society demands something of every man - it is something the individual owes humanity - the giving of one's self for his fellow man whether it be tangible or intangible.

Section 4.

It shall also be a specific function of this chapter to encourage in its Members the attainment of high scholastic standing; to make available to its Members the example, environment, and training that best characterizes the university man; to identify student and Alumni more closely with their university: to foster a more vigorous loyalty to alma mater; and to promote the social and intellectual spheres, the best traditions of the university.

Section 5.

In pursuit of these objectives, the chapter will seek to inculcate in its members a deep spiritual approach to the problem of man's life and death; to instill in its members a strong belief in the true destiny of man and his consequent human dignity and worth; to endeavor to cultivate within its members a genuine sense of responsibility of the social and spiritual needs of their fellow men; and deepen their love of truth, justice, and freedom.

Section 6.

In its attempt to live by the ideals of the Phi, the Kappa, and the Theta, the chapter shall encourage its Members to develop qualities of human understanding, companionship, kindness, discipline, sincerity, selflessness, loyalty, pride, and social responsibility.

—Article II. Supreme Governing Body—

Section 1.

The supreme governing body of the Indiana Zeta Chapter of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity shall be the regular chapter meeting, operating in accordance with the International Constitution of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity, the Constitution of the Chapter.

Section 2.

Chapter meetings shall follow parliamentary procedures according to Robert's Rules of Order.

—Article III. Meetings—

Section 1.

Meetings of this chapter shall be held every week of the school year on Sundays at 4:00 PM.

Section 2.

Any regular meeting may be postponed by the Chapter President or a majority of the active Members for a sufficient reason to a time not exceeding two weeks from the last regular meeting.

Section 3.

Special meetings may be held at any time at the discretion of the President or upon a written request of one-half of the active members in good standing; such a request shall state the subject of the meeting and place thereof; no other business shall be transacted than that which required the meeting.

Section 4.

A "paper meeting" may be conducted as an informational update on meeting weeks where the chapter's schedule is committed to major university events and meeting in person is not possible or practical (i.e. Homecoming, Grand Prix, Finals Week). Members must read the meeting announcements and answer three online follow up questions before recording online attendance to receive credit for attending a paper meeting.

Section 5.

A eighty percent of the active members in good standing shall constitute a quorum for the transaction of business.

Section 6.

Every member shall attend all regular and special meetings unless excused for good reason by the Chapter President. Unexcused absences from meetings shall be subject to penalty as provided in Article XI - Section 5 of the Bylaws.

Section 7.

The order of the full chapter business meeting shall be:

1. Formal Introduction and Prayer

2. Introduction of Visitors and Guests

3. Reading and Approval of Previous Meeting Minutes

4. Old Business

5. Report of Officers
    a.
    b. Vice President of Fraternal Development
    c. Vice President of Leadership Development
    d. Vice President of Societal Development
    e. Vice President of Intellectual Development
    f. Vice President of Spiritual Development
    g. President

6. Alumni Advisor's Report

7. New Business

8. Comments for the Good of the Chapter

9. Closing Statements

10. Singing of the Phi Kappa Theta Doxology

11. Adjournment

The order of the Associate Member meeting shall include:

1. Call to Order
2. Reading and Approval of Meeting Minutes
3. President's Report
4. Vice President of Fraternal Development's Report
5. Associate Member Educator's Report – Excused to Active Meeting After Report
6. Old Business
7. New Business
8. Review of Action Step for Next Meeting
9. Announcements
10. Adjournment

The order of the Active Member meeting shall include:

1. Call to Order
2. Reading and Approval of Meeting Minutes
3. President's Report
4. New Member Educator Report on Associate Member Class
5. Old Business
6. New Business
7. Announcements
8. Adjournment

Section 7.

Alumni may participate in discussion and debate; however, only active members of the chapter may propose, second, and vote on motions.

Section 8.

Proper dress code shall be observed during specified chapter meetings. For the first chapter meeting of each month, the dress code will be defined as a suit or business attire which includes dress shirt, tie, and brotherhood badge. The dress code for all other chapter meetings will be defined as casual.

—Article IV. Membership—

Non-Discrimination Statement

Membership and participation are free from discrimination on the basis of race, religion, color, sex, age,national origin or ancestry, genetic information, marital status, parental status, sexual orientation,
gender identity and expression, disability, or status as a veteran.

*Social fraternities and sororities are permitted by Title IX to deny membership on the basis of sex.

Section 1.

Any Purdue University student, faculty member or staff member who subscribes to the purpose and basic policies of the organization may become a member of this organization, subject only to compliance with the provisions of the constitution.

Section 2.

Active membership is restricted to Purdue University students. Associate membership is restricted to Purdue University faculty and staff. Associate members are non-voting members. Advisors may not vote or hold office in the organization.

Section 3.

Regularly enrolled male students and faculty Members of Purdue University who are sincerely interested in the aims, purposes, ideals, and traditions of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity as outlined in the Constitution of Phi Kappa Theta (Article I, Section 2) and who personally wish to pursue a mode of conduct and living in accordance with the same shall be eligible for membership in this Chapter.

Section 4.

The brothers shall judge each applicant in the spirit of brotherhood, looking only at the qualities which make a person a gentleman.

Section 5.

A brother in good standing is defined as one who is:

A. An active member of the chapter
B. Up to date on all financial obligations
C. Not on trial for any grievance against the organization

Section 6.

Candidates eligible for membership shall be elected by the members in good standing with the chapter. A seventy-five percent affirmative vote of the members of the Chapter shall be sufficient to elect a candidate for membership.

Section 7.

Transfer students, regularly initiated into Phi Kappa Theta at another chapter, may be elected by a majority vote to affiliate with this chapter, and the Executive Offices of Phi Kappa Theta shall be notified by the Vice President of Fraternal Development.

Section 8.

Selected interested professional, business, faculty, and others of the community shall be elected, by at least a majority vote of the Chapter, to Alumnus Membership (Honorary Membership).

—Article V. Executive Board—

Section 1.

The following officers of the Chapter shall serve on the Executive Board: President, Vice President of Fraternal Development, Vice President of Leadership Development, Vice President of Spiritual Development, Vice President of Intellectual Development, Vice President of Societal Development. The following Executive Board Officers also constitute the line of officer succession.

Section 2.

Executive Board meetings will be held weekly on Tuesdays before regular chapter meetings. If a Executive Board member has been excused from the meeting by the President, he will submit his report in writing to the President for presentation.

Section 3.

Decisions made by the Executive Board, provided they are within the responsibilities of the Executive Board and do not infringe on those delegated to the chapter in this or the General Fraternity's Constitution, shall be considered binding upon the chapter unless overruled by a two-thirds vote of the chapter at a regular meeting.

NOTE: It is best to present most council decisions to the chapter for a vote.

Section 4. President

The Chapter President serves as the chief executive and operating officer of the chapter. He oversees strategic planning, external relations, chapter operations, and member accountability. He acts as the liaison between the chapter and the university, alumni, and national fraternity.

Section 5. Vice President of Fraternal Development

Responsible for managing the Fraternal Development team, this officer oversees chapter finances, budgeting, recruitment, associate member education, alumni engagement, and brotherhood activities. He ensures accurate reporting and financial accountability.

Per SAO Regulations, The Vice President of Fraternal Development (Treasurer) will be responsible for ensuring adherence to the consulting organization project process as developed by the University; ensuring that University issued Supporter Agreements and Statements of Project are completed as required for each project. The Vice President of Fraternal Development must keep accounts, deposit the organization's funds, and make expenditures in a manner approved by the Business Office for Student Organizations.

Section 6. Vice President of Societal Development

This officer leads the Social Development team, focusing on risk management, social event planning, and public relations. He ensures all chapter activities align with safety policies and

promote positive community engagement.

Section 7. Vice President of Spiritual Development

Charged with fostering spiritual growth, this officer coordinates spiritual development programming, manages fraternity rituals, and supports members in moral and ethical decision-making. In addition, he plans the chapter's community service and philanthropy efforts. He works closely with the chapter's Spiritual Mentor and Ritual Coordinator.

Section 8. Vice President of Intellectual Development

This officer maintains the chapter's academic standards and promotes lifelong learning. He manages the academic plan, coordinates educational programming, and ensures members have access to academic resources and incentives.

Section 9. Vice President of Leadership Development

Responsible for developing leadership skills within the chapter, this officer coordinates leadership training, professional development, and educational programming. He works with campus resources and ensures alignment with the fraternity's mission and vision.

Section 10. Recruitment Chair

The recruitment chair will work directly with the Vice President of Societal Development. His main goal is to foster an authentic and welcoming environment that prospective students will want to join. This is done through scheduling recruitment rush events in conjunction with the Vice President of Societal Development and training members on positive interactions. During the general semester, the focus should be on potential member leads and tabling interactions. This position is appointed; the Vice President of Societal Development will select this chair, and then be confirmed by a majority vote of the Executive Board.

Section 11. Associate Member Educator

The Associate Member Educator will work directly with the Vice President of Leadership Development. He is in charge of associate member education ensuring members acclimate into the Fraternity through our development areas and brotherhood with others. He is also required to maintain compliance with Purdue FSCL and IFC through timely submission of schedules and APFs for these events. This position is appointed; the Vice President of Societal Development will select this chair, and then be confirmed by a majority vote of the Executive Board.

—Article VI. Creation of New Officer Positions—

Section 1. Proposal Process

Any active member in good standing may propose the creation of a new officer position. The proposal must include:

- A written draft of the position's title and responsibilities.
- Justification for the position's necessity and alignment with chapter goals.
- Suggested placement within the chapter's organizational structure.

Section 2. Review and Approval

The proposed position must be:

- Reviewed by the Executive Board for feasibility and alignment with chapter and national fraternity standards.
- Presented at a regular chapter meeting for discussion.
- Approved by a two-thirds vote of the active membership in good standing.

Section 3. Implementation

Upon approval:

- The position shall be added to the Constitution under Article V with a formal description.
- The role may be filled through a special election or added to the next regular election cycle.
- The position must be reported to the Office of Student Activities and Organizations for recognition and compliance.

Section 4. Amendment Clause

Any newly created officer position is subject to amendment or removal following the procedures outlined in Article XIII of this Constitution.

—Article VII. Officer Eligibility—

Section 1.

Any active member of this chapter shall be eligible to hold any office, provided that:

A. He has been an active member for at least one semester.
B. He has a grade point average of 2.50 or higher (defined as cumulative GPA).
C. He is not on academic probation with the fraternity or the university.
D. He is a member in good standing and is not in default with respect to financial or other obligations to the chapter.
E. He is a full-time student (12+ attempted credit hours for undergraduate students, 9+ hours for graduate students).

Section 2.

Provision A, B, and C of Section 1 may be waived by a two-thirds majority vote of the active membership in good standing with the fraternity.

Section 3.

To be eligible for presidency, a brother must first hold any of the Vice President positions for at least one semester prior to running for this office.

Section 4.

The tenure of office shall be for one year.

Section 5.

Any officer of this chapter who shall be found guilty of willful neglect of duty or actions not representative of this chapter and Phi Kappa Theta may, upon a three-fourths vote of the total chapter membership, be removed from office. Removal procedure will require a written motion signed by at least five members in good standing and presented before the chapter at a chapter meeting and discussed. At the following chapter meeting, after more discussion, a secret paper or electronic ballot shall be taken on the motion. The ballots will be destroyed after the outcome of the vote.

—Article VIII. Elections—

Section 1.

Nominations shall take place at the first Chapter of every April. Any member in good standing may nominate any qualified member for any office (see Article VI, Section 1).

Nominations shall be submitted electronically. The Vice President of Leadership Development will serve as the election official, creating a slate of nominees for each office along with nominations from the floor. If any motions to exempt requirements of office are brought forward (see Article VII, Sections 2 & 3), these votes will be held after all nominations have been heard.

Section 2.

Elections shall be held the Sunday before the start of Quiet Week, with no new nominations being accepted.

Section 3.

Officers shall be installed and assume duties at the last chapter meeting of the

spring semester.

Section 4.

In case of a plurality in the vote, the two men with the highest number of votes shall be the candidates for the specific office. Another vote will be taken on the two with the losing candidates participating in the vote. If a consensus still cannot be reached, the decision will be passed on to the standing President, unless he himself is in the running. In which case, it will be passed on to the next officer in the line of succession as defined in Article V.

Section 5.

The President may move elections forward or backward one week with the approval of the chapter.

Section 6.

Eligibility for elections will be determined after speeches are given with a three-fourths vote of the active membership, provided a quorum (eighty percent of the active body) is present.

—Article IX. Voting—

Section 1.

All motions require a majority vote unless otherwise stated in this Constitution, By-laws, the National Constitution of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity, or Robert's Rules of Order.

Section 2.

No member shall be permitted to vote by proxy unless otherwise stated in this Constitution or By-laws.

Section 3.

Voting on motions shall be by the usual sign, unless a secret ballot is directed by the President, or demanded by at least five members in good standing.

Section 4.

No motions shall be made through any other medium than live interaction.

Section 5.

If proof can be presented that a brother participated in blackmail, bribery, or extortion in order to obtain a desired vote, he must immediately be brought to trial without a hearing to determine the eligibility of their continued membership.

—Article X. Officer Vacancies and Resignations—

Section 1. Resignation of Officers

Any officer of the Chapter may resign his office by submitting a written resignation to the Chapter President. A resignation shall become effective upon acceptance by a majority vote of the active membership present at a regular or special chapter meeting.

Section 2. Temporary Assumption of Duties

Upon the resignation, removal, suspension, or incapacity of an officer, the duties of the vacant office shall be assumed immediately by the next officer in the line of succession as defined in Article V, Section 1, until the vacancy is filled.

Section 3. Filling Vacancies

A vacancy in any elected office shall be filled by a special election conducted at the next regular chapter meeting, provided notice of the election has been given to the membership. A majority vote shall be required to elect a replacement.

Section 4. Term of Replacement Officers

An officer elected to fill a vacancy shall serve for the remainder of the unexpired term.

Section 5. Presidential Vacancy

In the event of a vacancy in the office of President, the Vice President of Fraternal Development shall assume the office of President for the remainder of the term unless the chapter, by majority vote, elects another qualified member to serve.

—Article XI. Suspension—

Section 1. Definition of suspension: Suspension is a status given to a brother of Phi Kappa Theta, either voluntarily or involuntarily. A brother on suspension has no Fraternity rights. These rights that the suspended Brother are denied include:

1. Attending Brotherhood events
2. Having a voice and vote at chapter meetings
3. Attendance at any and all fraternity social functions including, but not limited to: date nights, socials, formals, tailgates and any social gathering held after a fraternity ritual.

Suspended brothers are allowed and encouraged to attend Fraternity rituals, Chapter meetings, and philanthropic events. However, the fraternity budget will not cover the cost or donation of a suspended brother for said events. A three-fourths vote of the chapter can overturn any suspension rule.

Section 2. Temporary Suspension:

The President and Vice President of Intellectual Development, when acting together, shall have the authority to suspend a brother temporarily until the next regular chapter meeting, which shall take place no more than 14 days after a brother has been suspended. At such meetings, the accused brother may present their appeal to the full chapter. A three-fourths vote of the active brotherhood is required to overturn the decision of the President and Vice President of Intellectual Development.

Section 3

3.1 Automatic Suspension (Less than one semester):

An active brother will be suspended from the chapter automatically for delinquency in meeting financial obligations. Delinquency is defined as meaning an account receivable of any kind which is 14 days past due, and where no written payment schedule has been arranged with the Executive Board.

3.2 Automatic Suspension (One semester or more):

An active brother will be suspended from the chapter automatically for any of the following:

A. Academic dismissal from the university
B. Conduct dismissal from the university.
C. Fiscal dismissal from the university.

Section 4

4.1 Voluntary Suspension (Less than one semester):

A Brother may petition the Executive Board for temporary suspension for less than one semester for academic or personal reasons. The brother is still responsible for all pre-existing fiscal obligations to the fraternity during this voluntary suspension period but is exempt from mandatory events. A simple majority of the Executive Board is required for voluntary suspension.

4.2 Voluntary Suspension (One semester or more):

In the event a brother chooses to go inactive, he must petition the chapter for voluntary suspension from the chapter for insurance purposes. A simple majority of active brothers are required for voluntary suspension.

A brother not enrolled as a Purdue University student does not need to request voluntary suspension since by definition a non-enrolled Brother is not active. The reason for voluntary suspension should fall among the following:

A. Academic reasons
B. Fiscal reasons
C. Personal reasons

Section 5.

5.1 Involuntary Suspension (Less than one semester):

An active brother may be suspended from the chapter for a period not to exceed a semester by a majority vote of the Active Brotherhood for any of the following:

A. Violations of this constitution or the National Fraternity's Constitution.
B. Unexcused absences from two consecutive chapter meetings.
C. Conduct unbecoming of a gentleman and a Phi Kappa Theta Brother.
D. Failure to attend chapter-approved activities.
E. Revealing private business of the chapter.
F. Using the name of Phi Kappa Theta without authority.

5.2. Involuntary Suspension (One semester or more):

An active brother may be suspended from the chapter for an indefinite amount of time by a majority vote of the active brotherhood for any of the following:

A. Violations of this or the National Fraternity's Constitution.
B. Unexcused absences from two consecutive chapter meetings.
C. Conduct unbecoming of a gentleman and a Phi Kappa Theta Brother.
D. Failure to attend chapter-approved activities.
E. Revealing private business of the Chapter.
F. Using the name of Phi Kappa Theta without authority.
G. Misappropriation of chapter funds.
H. Conviction of a felony by a civil court.

Section 6. Reinstatement:

A brother suspended for less than one semester does not need to petition the Chapter for reinstatement, but must fulfill all conditions established at the time of the suspension as set by the Standards Board (such as attendance at chapter meetings, initiation, community service, short courses, fines, counseling, etc.) and approved by a three-fourths vote of the chapter. Upon meeting all conditions of the suspension, the brother will automatically be reinstated with all rights, privileges, and responsibilities of active membership.

—Article XII. Associate Membership—

Section 1.

A minimum of a majority vote of active members in the Chapter at any regular or special meeting may pass a prospect for Associate Membership.

Section 2.

To disassociate a candidate, seventy-five percent of active brothers in good standing within the chapter shall be in attendance, all such brothers having been previously notified of the proposed vote upon a candidate before the formal secret ballot (or non-secret ballot) may be taken. One-third of the active members may drop an associate member.

Section 3.

Rejected candidates shall not be reconsidered unless a motion for reconsideration is made by a member who voted with the one-third dissenting. A three-fourths vote by active members in good standing is required for reconsideration.

Section 4.

Each candidate for initiation shall meet the minimum scholastic requirements for the chapter and the university: Minimum 2.5 GPA and in Good Academic Standing.

Section 5.

Associate member fees are payable BEFORE the associate member pinning ceremony, and due to the general fraternity within ten (10) days of the ceremony.

—Article XIII. Initiation—

Section 1.
Candidates for active membership shall achieve a minimum of 2.5 GPA on 12 credit hours from the previous semester.

Section 2.
No Candidate for membership shall be initiated until he has paid to the chapter, a sum sufficient to meet all fees payable to the National Fraternity and to the Chapter.

Section 3.
The Big Brother of each associate member shall speak on the merits of his Little Brother. Active members may answer questions about the Associate member's academic, leadership and personal character attributes. The Big Brother will answer these questions truthfully and completely before a formal vote of each associate member for initiation into the Indiana Zeta Chapter.

Section 4
Each associate member will be voted for initiation into Indiana Zeta Chapter one by one through a secret ballot with three fourths of the members voting for initiation for each associate member with a quorum present. Each secret ballot will be counted by the Scribe and then certified by the President at the active meeting, announcing the result of the vote. The decision of each vote will stay secret by the active membership prior to initiation. Ballots for each vote will be destroyed after the votes have been counted.

Section 5
Neither the Chapter nor individual Brothers shall subject any Associate Member to pre-initiation or hazing activities or practices, which involve physical or psychological abuse and are in any way dangerous, rude, vulgar, degrading, or humiliating.

Section 6.

The formal initiation ritual shall be a required attendance function for all active members, unless excused by a three-fourths vote of brothers in good standing. All excuses must be considered at the chapter meeting prior to initiation to be valid. A special meeting may be called to consider initiation procedures and excuses if the regular chapter meeting is deemed to be an unfit time to discuss such things.

Section 7.

Only the formal Initiation ritual of Phi Kappa Theta Fraternity shall officially constitute the initiation ceremony of the fraternity.

Section 8.

In addition to meeting the academic requirement, associate members must achieve membership in at least one other Purdue University affiliated organization during their associate member semester in order to be initiated into the brotherhood. The validity of a specific organization fulfilling this requirement shall be determined by the Internal Vice

President, with the approval of the Executive Board.

—Article XIV. Amendments—

Section 1.

This Constitution may be amended by a three-fourths vote of all brothers in good standing and be presented at any regular chapter meeting, provided such amendments shall have been read and presented in writing in at least one previous chapter meeting.

Section 2.

The bylaws may be amended by a two-thirds vote of all brothers in good standing present at any regular chapter meeting, provided such amendment shall have been read and presented in writing in at least one previous chapter meeting.

Section 3.

This constitution and bylaws shall become effective and be binding upon the present and future brothers of the chapter when adopted by a three-fourths vote of the total brotherhood.

Section 4.

In order for an amendment to be proposed at a chapter meeting, it must be drafted beforehand by the brother seeking to bring the amendment forward for discussion. A proposal lacking a draft for what should be added or changed in the constitution or bylaws is not considered valid, and therefore cannot be voted on. A brother may seek the help of the Scribe in preparing a draft.

Section 5.
Amendment Clause
All amendments to the constitution and bylaws are subject to the approval of the Office of Student Activities and Organizations. They MAY NOT take effect until they have been approved.

President's Signature	Student Activities and Organizations Office
Date of Adoption	Date of Recognition
Advisor's Signature	